



PROGRESS REPORT

Innovation ecosystem: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-09-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

54 countries. Each row below is carried verbatim from that country's own progress report, which answers a fixed frame of indicators over the period; nothing is written here. A country not listed under an indicator has **No evidence** on it in its own report.

TECHNOLOGY HUBS · TECH STARTUP ECOSYSTEM

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Technology hubs

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	An artificial-intelligence and cybersecurity startup cluster opened at Sidi Abdellah on 18 April 2026. The cluster did not exist at the window's opening. 2026-04-18 - it opened and is operating, inside a target of 20,000 startups by 2029. No tenancy, occupancy or employment figure has been published since. It is the only physical hub on this ledger, and the target it sits inside is roughly a hundred and fifty times the 130 startups the state venture arm reported by mid-2025.	ADVANCED
Angola	A science and technology park was inaugurated in June 2026 under a US\$100m development-bank project, and a public-finance innovation lab launched. 2026-06-29 — a science and technology park was inaugurated under a US\$100m development-bank science and technology project, intended to link academia, research, companies and young entrepreneurs. No tenant, occupancy, disbursement or operating budget is published. 2026-03-30 — a finance-ministry innovation lab launched, its first proof of concept qualified digital signatures in an internally built document system, with no budget, headcount or project pipeline published. Against them, an incubation programme agreed in March 2025 offering institutional and technical support, physical space, training and investor introductions has published no cohort, intake number, graduate or funding outcome in seventeen months. Two new buildings and no reported occupants is the shape of the evidence.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Benin	The skills hub network continues with a university partnership, a francophone digital-skills programme and an annual digital week. The hub network operates with a Sorbonne partnership and online hubs, alongside a francophone digital-skills programme and an annual digital week, the skills programme having been reported in October 2025. It was operating at the start of the window and nothing reports a change. No cohort size, graduate count, funding figure or company formation is published, so a hub network that is the country's flagship innovation asset produces no measurable output on this record. The two domestic firms named on this ledger, reported under production capacity, are not stated to have come through it.	NO CHANGE
Botswana	UniPod Botswana opened with ten specialised laboratories and six start-ups at commercial acceleration stage. 2023 — an independent policy review names the digital and innovation hub, the technology research institute and the agricultural research institute among the national system's hub institutions. 2026-02-26 — the higher education minister toured UniPod Botswana, described as the first of its kind in the country, with ten specialised laboratories and six start-ups at commercial acceleration stage. 2026-07-27 — South Africa's technology innovation agency and the Botswana Digital and Innovation Hub agreed a five-year joint programme and fund covering co-funding, commercialisation and cross-border ecosystem development. No occupancy, funding or graduation figure is published for any hub.	ADVANCED
Burundi	A hub reports incubating a programme targeting 40,000 entrepreneurs across two cities, and government published an account of a national digital festival. A field-based mapping of the entrepreneurship and innovation sector lists hubs and support organisations with a gap analysis, and is explicitly not an exhaustive register — so no national hub count can be taken from it, and none exists elsewhere in the base. 2026-02 — a hub set out its own incubation role in a national programme run with government, a development agency and three financing bodies, targeting 40,000 young and women entrepreneurs, with facilities in two cities. Self-published, so the reach is the hub's own claim. 2026-06-24 — a national digital festival was opened by the finance and digital economy ministry, organised with a professional centre and the World Bank project — a government account of a hub-run event, which is the firmer of the two records.	ADVANCED
Cameroon	A climate innovation hub launched at a Yaounde university, and a sixth digital centre opened in the Far North. 2025-10-02 - an incubation and collaboration platform launched at a Yaounde university for renewable energy, sustainable agriculture, waste and urban resilience, with no budget, cohort or funding figure published. 2026-05 - an operator inaugurated a sixth centre at a Far North university, with 481 young people trained and 50 international certifications issued since technical opening. The training figures are the company's own and unaudited, the source is a wire item, and no dated prior count of centres is held, so the sixth is dated and the first five are not.	ADVANCED
Cape Verde	The state innovation body launched a diaspora initiative in March 2026 alongside its standing scholarship and startup programmes. The body is stated to support 200 young people a year on scholarships, fund about 100 startups with six minimum salaries for two co-founders, and finance attendance at international events, and is the implementing body named for the diaspora initiative, the public-sector hackathon and the digital-skills rollout. All programme figures are government-reported and unchanged in stated design; the awards it runs are its most visible output. 2026-03 - it launched an initiative to connect diaspora entrepreneurs, talent and investment to domestic opportunities, the launch event convened to shape the platform, its structure and operating model presented rather than opened. No budget, legal basis, target or timetable is held.	ADVANCED
Central African Republic	A foundation founded in 2023 describes itself as the country's first incubator and announced a partnership in February 2026. The foundation, founded in 2023, describes itself as the country's first incubator dedicated to youth and diaspora entrepreneurs and states a three-year ambition. It is its own account of itself. 2026-02-28 - a partnership with a national initiative was announced. Alongside it sits a digital training centre and incubator financed at EUR 17m by the European Union and EUR 13m by a development bank, with a stated capacity of 50 trainees. No cohort size, funding raised, graduate count or surviving venture is published for either.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Chad	A state technology hub was created by arrete in September 2025 and launched on 30 October, covering incubation, laboratories and skills training. The centre was created by arrete of 1 September 2025 issued by the secretary general of the Presidency and publicly launched on 30 October 2025, its remit covering a digital library, incubation of Chadian technology start-ups, research and development laboratories, digital-skills training and the digitalisation of the administration (hub). No tenant list, cohort size or budget figure is published for it. Around it sits the youth entrepreneurship fund launched in July 2020 at 30 billion FCFA with information and communication technology among eligible sectors (fund).	ADVANCED
Comoros	A technology park pilot launched in January 2026 at US\$4,090,000 over 2025 to 2028, targeting 2,000 people trained. 2026-01-29 - the pilot launched at the Palais du peuple with a supplier present, costed at US\$4,090,000, about KMF 1,720,000,000, over 2025 to 2028 with World Bank support, targeting 2,000 Comorians trained with 30 per cent women, five mobile science caravans covering about ninety localities a year and 500 small enterprises, with twelve young people trained so far through the supplier partnership, ten of them building projects, previewed the week before. No enrolment, completion or spend figure has been published since, and no line of appropriation for it appears anywhere in the 2026 vote. Twelve trained against a target in the low thousands is where the record stands.	ADVANCED
Cote d'Ivoire	The first digital-fabrication laboratory was handed over in July 2026, and a government innovation lab was launched. 2026-07-08 to 13 - the country's first digital-fabrication laboratory was handed over at a public technical school with the national education ministry as contracting authority, running 16 functional zones across five poles equipped to Fab Academy standards, at a total project cost put at over FCFA 800m across the UN development programme, Japan, the African Development Bank, the World Bank and Ivorian public and private institutions. No per-financier split, operating budget or sustainment funding is stated. 2026-07-29 - a government innovation lab was launched to publish state digitalisation projects for direct bidding by start-ups and small firms, with no project list, budget or award record published.	ADVANCED
Djibouti	An innovation platform was launched by the digital economy ministry in July 2026, with no user or service figures. The platform did not exist at the window's opening. 2026-07 - it was launched by the Minister Delegate for the Digital Economy and Innovation, with no user or service figures published. The account is trade press reporting a ministry announcement, and the platform is distinct from a private marketplace of the same name. No incubator, accelerator or technology park appears anywhere else on this ledger, so a ministry-run platform with no published usage is the whole of the country's hub provision.	ADVANCED
DR Congo	A fourth edition of the Kinshasa digital innovation summit was held on 25 and 26 November 2025, renamed and locally organised. Three prior editions ran under a different name in partnership with a Moroccan firm. The fourth was renamed and localised, organised by a Congolese firm with a fintech-association partnership, an innovation village, free student entry and presidency backing, and held on 25 and 26 November 2025. No dates are held for the three earlier editions and no 2026 edition is held. The base carries no incubator, accelerator, fab lab or technology park for this country at all, so an annual conference is the whole of what the indicator can be answered with.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Egypt	A regional headquarters and first global generative-artificial-intelligence centre of excellence opened in New Cairo, backed by a stated US\$100m. A memorandum between the state and the company was signed in January 2025 with no facility. 2026-07 - a regional headquarters for the Middle East and Africa plus the group's first global generative-artificial-intelligence centre of excellence was inaugurated, backed by a company-stated US\$100m, with about 800 staff and company targets of 1,000 by end-2026 and about 3,000 by end-2028, the group's agentic platform developed, tested and localised by Egyptian teams, reported in the national press. A second delivery centre opened with about 250 engineers and more than 380 further jobs stated, the group saying the Egyptian centre is planned to become its second largest worldwide and that about 85% of its business is export-directed. Six technology parks are recorded as under development at Minya, Menoufiya, Mansoura, Sohag, Qena and Aswan with no completion date, cost or occupancy stated, and no source since updates any of them; university technology parks were separately named as a next step with no instrument or date.	ADVANCED
Equatorial Guinea	A digital transformation forum convened in July 2026 naming artificial intelligence, electronic payments and public-administration reform as its three priority axes. It was backed by the national development agency (forum). It is the only convening of the technology sector the base holds, and no hub, incubator, accelerator or workspace appears anywhere in the record.	ADVANCED
Eritrea	One technology hub is documented: a youth union training centre teaching electronics, programming and robotics (account). The Youth Innovation and Entrepreneurship Hub, established in 2023 by the national union of Eritrean youth and students, runs three levels of six-month technical training in electronics, Python, Scratch, robotics and soldering, primarily for students in grades 9 to 11 (account). It is the clearest documented operating technology hub in Eritrea, and it is a training centre rather than an incubator: nothing on the base records a company founded through it, investment placed or a product taken to market. No commercial or university-attached hub is recorded anywhere.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position and one hub on the base
Eswatini	The science park incubator opened an international pitch route in May 2026, and a regional youth hub awarded E42,000 in seed capital in August. The science park's business incubator offers co-working space, business development, intellectual property and fundraising support to early-stage companies (incubator), and in May 2026 launched a national leg of an international startup pitch competition with a venture firm (competition). Fifty young entrepreneurs took a four-week incubation programme at a regional hub run by the youth council with the small enterprise development company, and five won a combined E42,000 in seed capital (programme). Two community innovation hubs are operating with a third planned for a third region, and a training curriculum in artificial intelligence, robotics and cybersecurity is announced for them with no start date, provider or cohort size. No cohort count, graduation figure or investment total is published for the science park's own incubator at any date.	ADVANCED
Ethiopia	An artificial intelligence innovation pod opened in February 2026, run with a development agency and the national university. The pod opened in February 2026 with the United Nations Development Programme and Addis Ababa University (innovation pod). It is the only hub the base holds: no incubator count, membership figure, funding total or record of what has come out of it is on file.	ADVANCED
Gabon	The state digital incubator lost its director general and its premises in August 2026, with a merger into the innovation centre under study. The director general was removed at a board meeting while he was abroad, the head office has been emptied with no new address announced, and the interim passed to a deputy of the state holding that owns 30% of the incubator's capital (incubator). Its claimed record since 2018 is 314 startups supported, about FCFA 550m mobilised and a 68% post-incubation survival rate (incubator), and no ministerial statement of its future is on file. Against that, a memorandum signed at the data-centre inauguration is to give ministry-supported start-ups professional hosting at preferential rates, with no rate, eligibility list or take-up figure published (hosting memorandum).	REGRESSED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gambia	A digital innovation sprint was held in July 2026 with the youth council, the ministry and a United Nations agency. No follow-on funding or incubation route is published (sprint). It is the only innovation event in the base, and a showcase without a route out of it is what the record shows. 2026 - the hub estate is listed rather than surveyed: four hubs appear in a continental directory - a disruptive lab, a technology company, a startup incubator and a co-working network, alongside a developer group chapter in the capital reporting about 992 members and running artificial-intelligence and civic-technology meetups. No membership, funding, cohort or survival figure is published for any of them.	ADVANCED
Ghana	A three-month fintech accelerator launched in August 2026 across three cities, alongside a university innovation centre running to 2027. The accelerator was launched by the dominant mobile-money operator with a domestic technology firm as official technology partner, running across Accra, Kumasi and Tamale; no cohort size, selection criteria, funding or equity terms are stated (accelerator). An advanced technology innovation centre at a public university runs on a US\$9m grant from a foreign development agency from 2022 to 2027 and is recorded as active, with no progress or outturn report held at any date (innovation centre).	ADVANCED
Guinea	Three Guinean organisations appear in the pan-African hub directory: an innovation centre, a digital-education hub and an incubator. The directory carries an innovation centre supporting projects in ICT, renewable energy and agribusiness, a hub working on mass digital education, and a non-profit incubator taking IT, renewable-energy and environmental startups and small firms through their early stages (directory). The count is a membership list rather than a census, so it records who has joined a continental network and not how many hubs operate in the country. No public hub programme, incubation funding line or count of firms supported is held.	NO CHANGE a first count with no earlier figure behind it
Guinea-Bissau	An operator's digital centre moved to a structured incubation and acceleration programme in April 2026. Hubs arrived in the window rather than before it. An incubator opened in Bissau in September 2025 training 15 youth entrepreneurs chosen from 52 proposals, and an operator's digital centre moved from ad hoc training to a structured incubation and acceleration programme in April 2026. Both are small and both are externally funded; neither publishes a graduate or survival figure.	ADVANCED
Kenya	A technopolis statute gives innovation cities a standalone legal framework, and three infrastructure agreements were signed at the flagship site in August 2026. The statute is in force with a development authority and a disputes tribunal, and its regulations are named as still to be finalised with no draft on file (statute, regulations). A hyperscaler signed a collaboration agreement providing technical leadership for a hybrid-cloud outpost and a startup and innovation centre of excellence, with cloud-adoption support for public bodies, certification courses for staff and young people, and credits for startups; it was signed five days after the talks were reported as exploratory, with no capacity, site, investment figure or delivery date stated and no procurement disclosed (agreement, talks). A Chinese network group signed a framework memorandum covering planning, investment, financing, design, development and maintenance of digital infrastructure at the same site, with the financing models themselves stated as still to be explored (memorandum). An African research and development lab is to be hosted at the largest commercial campus on sovereign compute, on an announcement with no opening date, funding, capacity or membership figure (lab).	ADVANCED
Lesotho	The innovation studio is operational with a second under way, alongside two incubation programmes. 2026-06-11 — the studio at the polytechnic was confirmed operational and ground was broken for a second. 2026-03-20 — an entrepreneurship hub opened its fifth incubation cycle with sixty enterprises selected. 2025-10-29 — the first software factory cohort graduated, eight in number. Three hubs are running and none publishes a survival, funding or employment figure for what leaves them.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Liberia	An innovation and digital hub operates under a continental development platform, with no commitment amount disclosed. It was named as a flagship contribution at the July 2026 technology summit (hub, investments). It is the only hub in the base, and it is a development agency's rather than the state's.	ADVANCED
Libya	A national incubator in Tripoli and a university incubator running a first competition. The small-enterprise programme runs a technology incubator with Tripoli premises, training and a seed-grant admission route. Universities are the other host. One crowned five ventures from more than 600 entries in its first technology competition in July 2026, and another added licensed design and certification training for students and startups through two agreements in February.	ADVANCED
Madagascar	A national innovation hub was inaugurated in May 2026 and a third digital centre opened in the north in June. The innovation hub was inaugurated in May 2026 at a science and technology centre in the capital, carrying five laboratories covering prototyping, robotics and artificial intelligence, agrifood, green technology and technology transfer (inauguration). An operator's digital centre opened at the University of Antsiranana in June 2026, extending a network that has run since 2021 and reports benefiting more than 12,000 young people (opening). A government-backed grant programme concluded its second cohort in January 2026, with 26 start-ups from 320 applications across eight regions taking USD 15,000 each (cohort).	ADVANCED
Malawi	An operator announced artificial-intelligence laboratories and innovation hubs for 2026 with nothing opened, and a university innovation lab grant reaches its scheduled end this year. The laboratories were announced at the operator's thirtieth-anniversary event for establishment in 2026, to let Malawians build artificial-intelligence-driven services; no site, budget, partner or opening date is stated and nothing on record shows one has opened (laboratories). A grant of US\$1,880,499 committed in 2019 equips a university innovation hub for ideation, prototyping, mentorship and incubation, with a scheduled end year of 2026 and no closure or extension on file (hub); the total budget is stated as US\$3.19m against that commitment (hub). The regulator runs an information and communications technology research and innovation fund, working with 70 start-ups at the time of report in March 2024 and stating a target of 250 in the following financial year (fund). No fund size, disbursement figure or list of recipients is held, and nothing on it since. The same account names one incubator, a development agency's accelerator lab and a smart-city project near completion at Mvera, and puts venture capital at virtually non-existent; no register or directory of hubs is published by anyone.	ADVANCED
Mali	An innovation fund's fourth cohort finished with five winners in July 2026, the fund having been officially launched in November 2025. The fund's first-phase tranche was implemented through a consortium in 2025 (tranche). No fund size, ticket size, portfolio or survival figure is published, and the cohort count is the only measure of reach on the record. Two assessments of the wider base are held and both are three or four years old: a digital innovation profile and a digital economy diagnostic (profile, diagnostic).	ADVANCED
Mauritania	A technology incubator at Nouakchott supports startups and small firms, and a one-day artificial-intelligence build was held in May 2026. The incubator presents itself as building an entrepreneurial base with economic, social and sustainable impact, accompanying startups and small and medium enterprises to growth (incubator). The build was held on 17 May 2026 to launch working projects in the country (build). Both records are the organisers' own sites: no cohort count, funding, survival rate, project outcome or public support is established from either.	ADVANCED
Mauritius	An AI City Scheme in the omnibus bill would certify a specialised hub carrying fiscal incentives, expedited permits and a founder permit at US\$1m invested. The certificate would cover a specialised technological and innovation hub promoting artificial intelligence, digital sectors, advanced computing infrastructure and advanced manufacturing, carrying fiscal incentives, duty exemptions, expedited permits and prescribed property acquisition, with a new founder occupation permit at US\$1m invested (scheme). It is an incentive and immigration scheme rather than a governance one, and it was introduced and not enacted. No existing hub, incubator or accelerator is separately recorded for the country.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Morocco	A fintech centre operates with no published figures, and an artificial-intelligence start-up programme with a technology park was announced in April 2026. The fintech centre was named by the minister at a payments industry event in June 2025, with no participant, funding or output figure held then or since; a start-up support programme is named alongside it, also without figures (centre). The start-up programme announced at an April 2026 exhibition offers cloud, connectivity, cybersecurity and business use cases to artificial-intelligence start-ups, with no cohort, intake or budget published and nothing on file since (programme).	ADVANCED
Mozambique	The state company owning the science and technology parks was extinguished and its 2012 founding decree revoked, while a regulator incubator network planned expansion from the capital to two more cities. 2026-06-16 — a decree extinguished the state company that owned and managed the science and technology parks, revoking its 2012 founding decree, in connection with the new digital transformation and innovation agency. It is the most significant institutional change to the hub-managing body in the window, and no successor arrangement for the parks themselves is stated. 2026-05-29 — the communications regulator set out a first-phase plan to expand its digital incubator network from the capital to Beira and Nampula, with an eventual every-province ambition. The assessment behind both is unflattering: an international review of the country's science, technology and innovation parks and hubs found the field nascent, with weaknesses in funding, coordination and university-industry linkage. Dissolving the owner and planning an expansion in the same quarter is not obviously one strategy.	MIXED the hub-owning state company was dissolved while an incubator network planned expansion
Namibia	A national artificial-intelligence institute recommended by a 2022 task force is proposed and not established, with no site, budget, host or founding instrument on file. The sixth national development plan calls for a research centre and the institute remains proposed (institute). Four years after the recommendation there is no site, budget, host or founding instrument. The working capability the country has instead sits in a university accelerator recorded separately.	NO CHANGE
Niger	A university innovation hub at Diffa reached project-document validation in August 2026 under a youth agripreneurship programme. A university was selected through a competitive process to host the hub, and the workshop validating its project document opened on 20 August 2026; no budget figure or opening date is published (hub). It is the only technology hub on record for the country, and it is at document-validation stage.	ADVANCED
Nigeria	The regulator leased two federal facilities to a state after failing to activate them, a digital free zone runs remote incorporation, and ten state hubs are planned. The regulator built buildings for outsourcing, incubation and skills and could not activate them, its executive vice chairman saying buildings alone do not create innovation, and leased them to the state for fifteen years to run as a talent city and an artificial-intelligence institute; both parties call the transfer temporary and reversible, and no rent, investment commitment or performance condition is stated (lease). The digital free zone is live for remote incorporation on a US\$100m first-phase commitment from a continental financier (zone). Ten state hubs are planned alongside the national talent programme (hubs), and a defence-technology firm holding a joint venture with the state arms corporation is to build robotics, drone and virtual-reality laboratories at a private university, with lab count, cost, funding, intake, research ownership and dual-use vetting all unstated (laboratories).	ADVANCED
Rwanda	A financial technology centre was inaugurated in March 2026, and an innovation city broke ground in September 2024 on an equity ticket never publicly disclosed. The centre was inaugurated on 12 March 2026, and the sector count and inclusion figure attached to it are the minister's (centre, hub role). The innovation city broke ground in September 2024 under a public-private partnership; the equity ticket is imputed and was never publicly disclosed (city). Neither carries an occupancy, tenant or output figure, so both are recorded as built rather than as working.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sao Tome and Principe	The incubator network built by the entrepreneurship ministry with a development agency, the mobile operator and a bank is operating as an intake point for the third startup competition. The ministry describes the network as structured physical spaces on both islands with meeting rooms, internet and access to tools and equipment, offering business management support, technical support and complementary training, aimed at students, scientists, entrepreneurs and firms developing technology-based projects (network). The third competition names the incubator in the capital as one of three intake points alongside the district councils and an online form (competition), which is dated in-window confirmation that it is operating. No count of incubated firms, occupancy figure, funding line or second location is published, so how much of the network described in 2021 exists on the ground is unestablished.	ADVANCED
Senegal	The accreditation platform for support structures opened in November 2025, and works restarted on the technology park. The [platform opened on 20 November 2025 under the digital ministry], which the minister described as moving the startup law into implementation, the law organising the relationship between startups and the structures that support them](2025-11-20-aps-ecosysteme-startup-plateforme-labellisation). The route it operates is set by the implementing decree: support structures must be accredited through a online procedure valid three years and renewable, with duties covering registration, equipped premises, coaching and training, and eligibility requiring a dedicated team, dedicated premises and at least three startups already supported, with accreditation attaching eligibility for public subsidies. The physical estate restarted: the minister visited the technology park site on 3 November 2025 and committed the government to delivering a first phase of 12.5 hectares by March 2026 – three towers, a research centre run with universities, an incubation centre, an audiovisual production centre and a training centre. It is a restart and a target date, not a commissioning.	ADVANCED
Seychelles	Three hubs are on record: a university innovation centre operating, a COMESA hub at groundbreaking, and an incubator opening its 2026 cohort. The University of Seychelles established its Centre for Innovation in 2025 under the Faculty of Research and Innovation as an incubator and accelerator connecting students, researchers, entrepreneurs and industry (centre); it is the clearest operating hub the base holds. Ground was broken at Ile Perseverance in July 2026 on a COMESA and AUDA-NEPAD partnership hub to house equipment procured under European technical assistance, with construction and operation expected in 2027 (groundbreaking). In August 2026 a conservation trust launched a Business, Technology and Innovation Incubator with up to twelve months' incubation, mentoring and access to seed funding (incubator). No cohort size or tenant count is published for any of them.	ADVANCED
Sierra Leone	A UniPod opened at Fourah Bay College in July 2026, above sixteen district digital learning hubs under establishment. The UniPod opened on the Mount Aureol campus, backed by government, the University of Sierra Leone, UNDP and Africell (hub). The innovation directorate's remit covers incubators, accelerators, innovation clusters, co-working spaces, research hubs and community hubs in underserved regions, and it lists sixteen district digital learning hubs as active work (directorate). A circular innovation lab for young people was announced with UNDP in March 2026 (lab). No hub is reported with occupancy, cohort numbers or a funding term, so none can be told apart from a launch.	ADVANCED
Somalia	A new hub opened in Bosaso in April 2026, and three existing hubs signed into a national network in July. A university opened an innovation and incubation hub in Bosaso with the youth ministry, the mayor and private-sector representatives present, extending the hub network into Puntland (opening). Innovation forums in Mogadishu and Hargeisa in July centred on the launch of a network linking three of the leading hubs under a memorandum, into a community of practice with harmonised incubation standards (launch). The regulator separately agreed a partnership with one of those hubs in July 2026. No count of hubs, tenants or capital placed is published.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
South Africa	Two centres opened in the window – a continental digital transformation centre with the ITU and an industry and technology centre hosted by a university. 2026-03-06 – the African Digital Transformation Centre opened at an innovation hub in the capital, established with the International Telecommunication Union as part of its network of acceleration centres, to support technology small enterprises and digital entrepreneurs across the continent. 2025-09-22 – a South African Centre for Industry and Technology was launched, hosted by a university in partnership with an international forum and opened alongside a G20 research and innovation ministerial. Beneath both, the small business department runs a standing network of incubation and digital hubs, on an undated page with no hub count, spend or enterprise figure. Two openings in a year and no occupancy, cohort or funding figure for any of them is the pattern: hubs are announced here and their output is not measured. An eight-month accelerator supporting twelve Southern African teams building affordable classroom AI tools launched on 9 September 2026, with seed funding for the five strongest at the end (programme).	ADVANCED
South Sudan	The mobile operator opened an ICT hub in Northern Bahr el Ghazal State as a digital-skills training, scholarship and innovation facility. 2026-08-31 – the mobile operator opened the Aweil ICT Hub in Northern Bahr el Ghazal State, opened at a ceremony attended by government, education-sector, youth and development-partner representatives and described as a digital-skills training, scholarship and innovation facility. No capacity, budget, term or intake figure is published, and no public instrument stands behind it: the hub is an operator's own facility, announced by the operator, in a state where the base holds no other hub. What the record cannot say is whether it will run past the announcement.	ADVANCED
Sudan	A regional project activated a university incubator in August 2026, alongside a standing technology transfer authority mandated to expand incubators. The finance ministry, the African Development Bank and the regional body launched the national component of an entrepreneurship and innovation project – regionally about USD 3.255 million, also covering South Sudan and Djibouti – delivered through the University of Khartoum's entrepreneurship incubator (launch). The research council's technology transfer authority, established in 2019, states a mandate to expand technological incubators and model production units and to move research outputs into production (mandate). A private organisation that builds out the startup sector runs its own hub (about). No count of active hubs is held.	ADVANCED
Tanzania	An international acceleration centre received final board approval two years after its host agreement, with no opening date attached. Final approval came at an international innovation board meeting in April 2026; two years from host agreement to board approval with no opening date is the finding (centre). One domestic company was named in a fifteen-startup accelerator cohort – the base's only named accelerator placement in the window (placement).	ADVANCED
Togo	A World Bank-funded hub opened at Lome on 7 May 2026; six prefecture centres are at tender stage. The hub runs a pre-incubation and a market-stage programme, with a partnership with a pan-African incubator to support about 72 Togolese start-ups between June 2026 and July 2027 and a fund of roughly EUR 15,000 average grants for about thirty entrepreneurs. It is named the first component of a planned national network of more than a hundred spaces, none of them dated. Six centres for the prefectures of Tone, Kozah, Tchaoudjo, Ogou, Kloto and Zio were announced in April 2026 with an architecture tender closing 30 April – a procurement step for construction, not an opening. Before both, the country had one such centre, at the University of Lome.	ADVANCED
Tunisia	Immediate procurement to complete a technology park was ordered in August 2026, and a digital summit held its tenth edition. No cost, completion date, occupancy plan or account of why the park was incomplete is stated (park). The summit reached its tenth edition in April 2026 (summit). An order for immediate procurement to finish a park, with no explanation of the delay, is the only thing published about it.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Uganda	Four regional innovation hubs were stated operational on the ministry's own count, and a bilateral memorandum builds on two centres that graduated 800 young women with 60 per cent reported employed. The four-hub count is the ministry's own with no user, cohort or budget figure published and the review report not on file (hubs). The bilateral memorandum was signed in February 2026 and builds on two existing centres that graduated 800 young women, 60 per cent of them reported employed (memorandum). A fintech forum was launched by the national university's incubation centre with a private partner; it is a forum, not a finance instrument (forum).	ADVANCED
Zambia	An innovation hub ran the nine-month pipeline that took a national team to global finals, and its chief executive says the talent pool is real but investment in research, technology and innovation is not. The chief executive's statement is his own account, given at the same event (hub). A digital economy incubator recruited facilitators and group coaches in August 2026; it is European Union-funded and delivered by a private hub with a non-governmental organisation, with no cohort size, budget or start date stated (incubator). One agricultural technology company exists because European traceability-compliance software was quoted at thousands to tens of thousands of dollars a month, on the founders' own account, with no revenue, farmer count, funding or independent evaluation held (company).	ADVANCED
Zimbabwe	Three hubs moved in 2026: a national information access centre in March, a university incubation centre in July, and a technology institute's expo in August. A national information access centre was commissioned in March 2026 at a state open university's Harare campus, through a partnership with South Korea's national information society agency (centre). The President commissioned a university industrial incubation centre in Msasa on 27 July 2026, giving technical support, mentorship and industrial collaboration to 11 start-up companies across agriculture, ICT, engineering, pharmaceuticals, health, transport and energy (incubation centre). A technology institute's innovation hub, carrying a technopreneurship development centre and a new centre for artificial intelligence, hosted a three-day expo from 28 to 30 July 2026 with an anticipated 10,000 participants (expo). The central bank's own innovation hub, announced in November 2025, still has no location, staffing or opening date on the base.	ADVANCED

Tech startup ecosystem

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	A student start-up and patent conversion scheme reports 673 start-ups and 3,949 patents, and listing fees are waived to 2028. 2026-02-03 - initial public offering fees were waived for startups to 2028, and a structured video-game and e-sports industry plan was announced with no instrument held. A ministerial order letting students convert final-year projects into start-ups or patents reports 673 start-ups, 3,949 patents and 2,339 innovative-project labels between 2022 and July 2026, against a 2030 target of 5,000 labelled products, supported by a prototype-financing scheme and the country's first venture-capital fund. The order's own date and text are not held and the figures are a newspaper's. On the composite measure the country ranked 115th of the 133 economies in the 2024 innovation index, which scores about 80 indicators grouped into innovation inputs and outputs. No later edition and no earlier position are held, so it is a first placing with no direction behind it.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Angola	A startups law passed unanimously with a revenue-ceiling definition, while the innovation ranking fell to 138th of 139 economies. 2026-03-23 — a startups law passed unanimously, defining a startup at an annual revenue ceiling of about US\$3.5m with no minimum threshold, so pre-revenue ventures qualify, after passage in generality four days earlier. Promulgation and gazette number are not held. The population it addresses has not moved. Fewer than 2% of identified startups have secured venture funding, with angel and seed structures largely absent, against about 125 startups and no exit event at the last assessment, with no newer count published by anyone including the sponsoring ministry. The one visible venture is the only entrant in a fifteen-startup accelerator cohort drawn from about 2,600 applications, raising US\$4.6m on AI credit scoring for motorcycle-taxi work. The innovation ranking fell to 138th of 139 economies, worse on outputs than inputs and with no cluster in the world's top innovation clusters, on a six-year trend running 132nd, 127th, 132nd, 133rd and now 138th. One startup is in court against a bank: Paga3's founders accuse Standard Bank Angola of using pilot information to build a similar product, a year on and awaiting interim relief (dispute).	MIXED a startups law passed while the innovation ranking fell to 138th of 139
Benin	Decret 2023-095 of 22 March 2023 sets how the start-up label is granted. Decret 2023-095 fixes the conditions on which the start-up label is granted to micro, small and medium enterprises, and the rights and obligations that come with it. No count of labelled firms, no register of them and no evaluation of what the label delivers is held.	NO CHANGE a standing instrument the base holds for the first time
Botswana	The innovation system ranked 87th of 139 in the 2025 Global Innovation Index, with early-stage finance diagnosed as nascent. 2021-12 — a technical note diagnoses the early-stage finance market as nascent. 2026-02-04 — the national innovation network met for the first time in January 2026, with participants naming fragmented pathways, siloed programmes and disjointed funding as the barriers. 2026-07-29 — a Bill to create a national research and innovation council was presented to Parliament, reporting the innovation system ranked 87th of 139 in the 2025 index with research and development intensity below 0.5 per cent of output. No count of active start-ups, funding rounds or exits is published. The sector's first census, published in 2026, counts more than 100 startups operating across fintech, e-commerce, agritech, artificial intelligence, mobility, edtech and healthtech, which together raised less than US\$10 million between 2019 and 2025. It puts a figure on what the 2021 diagnostic could only call nascent; both are the publisher's own compilation rather than a deal database.	ADVANCED against a market still described as nascent
Burkina Faso	An innovation platform for inventors and diaspora projects was announced in October 2025, and the innovation ranking stands unchanged at 129th of 133. 2025-10-24 — a platform for inventors and diaspora innovators to register projects toward local manufacture was announced by the head of state, routed to an incubator described as under construction. No operational statement or user count has followed in ten months. The country stood 129th of 133 economies and 23rd of 27 in sub-Saharan Africa on the last innovation index profile held, and no 2025 or 2026 profile is on the base, so the only comparative benchmark this section has is two years old. The firms that do appear on this ledger arrived without either instrument: a hosting provider, a payments aggregator and a multi-operator wallet application, reported under storage and payments.	ADVANCED on an announced platform with no operating statement behind it
Burundi	A business-plan competition opened to small enterprises with the digital economy among its priority sectors, from a base of no venture or angel finance. A country diagnostic states digital entrepreneurship is embryonic, with one tech hub and no venture capital or angel finance. 2026-03-16 — a World Bank-financed project launched a business-plan competition supporting micro, small and medium enterprises, with information technology and the digital economy among the priority sectors. It is the largest in-window support and finance mechanism reaching Burundian startups and it is not startup-specific, which is itself the finding: the country has no startup act, no dedicated fund and no incubator financing line on this ledger. No award, cohort size or committed amount has been published against the competition.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cameroon	A national funding-match platform launched in January 2026, against two funded startups raising US\$300,000 in 2025. 2026-01-22 - the trade ministry launched a national platform matching small businesses and young entrepreneurs to national and international funding, with no user, listing or disbursement figure published. The funding it exists to match is thin. An annual tracker records two funded startups raising US\$300,000 in calendar 2025, of which US\$100,000 was artificial intelligence, 0.2% of the African total - a self-declared minimum floor counted by funded venture, and not commensurable with other trackers. No prior-year Cameroonian figure on the same basis is held.	ADVANCED on two funded ventures raising US\$300,000 in the year
Cape Verde	A 2026 hackathon edition ran for public-sector challenges, while the foundation allocated for in FY2024 is uncreated. The hackathon is a running programme in which startups solve challenges set by public and private institutions; its two-day 2026 edition ran for public-sector challenges with national and diaspora participants, supported by the World Bank Group, the digital economy ministry, the telecommunications directorate, the state innovation body and the national university, with four teams recognised. The exact dates are not published. The science, innovation and technology foundation provided for by an allocation in the FY2024 budget has not been created, with no evidence of it at 2026-08-06. A university and economy ministry partnership on innovation, entrepreneurship and employment is projected rather than signed, with no scope, funding or programme published.	MIXED a public-sector hackathon ran a fresh edition while the science and innovation foundation provided for in the FY2024 budget has not been created
Central African Republic	Bitcoin's legal-tender status was revoked, the state token is defunct with the status of invested funds unclear, and the presidential coin lost more than 75% of its value. Parliament amended the April 2022 cryptocurrency law and revoked bitcoin's legal-tender status, making acceptance optional, with no restoration or replacement instrument recorded. The country was the first African state to adopt it. The state-sponsored token is defunct: 10% of a 210-million token target sold, under EUR 2m raised, the promised crypto city and island never built, the website offline and the status of funds already invested recorded as unclear. It had been marketed with passports at US\$60,000 and land at US\$10,000 held in the token. The presidential meme coin passed US\$900m in market capitalisation over its launch weekend and then lost more than 75% of its value, and remains the payment rail for the tokenised land concessions, with no evidence that its revenues were declared as public income or entered the national budget. The rest of the private technology record is two named firms with no dated transaction: no startup, accelerator cohort, funding round or sector revenue figure exists for the country.	REGRESSED
Chad	There is no start-up statute; a youth entrepreneurship fund of 30 billion FCFA lends through banks under a 70 per cent state guarantee. Loi n. 005/PR/MFB/2020 of 26 May 2020 created the fund, launched on 11 July 2020 at 30 billion FCFA, lending entirely through banks under a 70 per cent state guarantee at a target rate of about 6.25 per cent, with information and communication technology among eligible sectors (fund). A state technology hub covering incubation, laboratories and skills training launched on 30 October 2025 (hub), and in December 2025 a challenge programme opened to identify, support and finance projects across all 23 provinces (challenge). No disbursement total, loan count or share going to technology ventures is published for any of them.	ADVANCED
Comoros	Ten hackathon finalists were funded at 1,500 to 5,000 euros each in August 2026; no start-up statute exists. 2026-05 - an employment facility signed financing agreements with eleven Comorian civil-society organisations across the three islands, the sectors covered including digital trades and incubators, continuing a first phase that ran from 2020. 2026-08 - a hackathon launched in April under a four million euro European Union programme trained a hundred young people and funded ten finalists at 1,500 to 5,000 euros each at its closing ceremony on 6 August, with incubation continuing at a local laboratory. The digitalisation support project runs to 2028 with the digital agency as executing agency. Every instrument here is a donor's. No start-up statute, tax regime or domestic innovation fund appears anywhere on file, so what happens when the programmes end is not knowable from the base.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Congo	A ride-hailing and delivery platform began operating in Brazzaville, while the labelling regime has not moved. 2025-11 - a platform began operating in Brazzaville with geolocated taxis, premium vehicles and hourly rentals, funded from a US\$30m round of equity and debt, entering a market a competitor had left. No later source reports fleet size, driver numbers or the promised financial and delivery layers. The startup labelling regime, with award and withdrawal procedures and a labelling commission established in council in July 2025, is unchanged: no source records a commission sitting, a label awarded or withdrawn, or any count of labelled startups. It is the only startup-specific instrument the base holds for the country.	MIXED a ride-hailing platform entered the market while the startup labelling regime has not produced a single labelled firm
Cote d'Ivoire	Funding raised rose to US\$17.92m in 2025 and two accelerator cohorts opened, while the Startup Act stayed unimplemented. A tracker report puts funding at US\$17,920,000 across three funded ventures in 2025, up 280% on US\$4,717,000 across four in 2024, of which financial technology took US\$17,000,000. Its method books undisclosed rounds at the lowest possible figure, so the totals are floors. 2026-07-29 - two cohorts of fifteen opened, one of trading startups and one of digital small and medium enterprises, each accompanied for 24 months, against a stated target of FCFA 5 to 10bn mobilised from banks, funds and donors - an ambition, not committed capital. A procurement platform to publish state projects for direct bidding was announced with them, with nothing establishing it is live. The Startup Act adopted in November 2023 still has no implementing decree, no count of labelled startups, no evaluation and no reported use of its public-procurement route. 2026-08-31 — a ten-year-old marketplace split its consumer and business activities and relaunched the consumer brand as Afrikrea, selling fashion, art and crafts internationally for African and diaspora creators with payment and delivery handled by the platform. No merchant count, transaction volume or revenue figure is published, and the terms of the split are not stated.	MIXED funding raised and two accelerator cohorts opened while the Startup Act has produced no implementing decree or count of labelled firms
Djibouti	The Startup Act is in force from promulgation with every operative detail deferred to implementing decrees, and none is held. The Act did not exist at the window's opening. It was signed on 1 December 2025 and carried in the official journal of 15 December, in force from promulgation with every operative detail deferred to implementing decrees, after advancing through November and being reported across the trade press. No decree is held as at 20 July 2026, so no label award, sandbox admission or visa issue can be stated. The regulatory sandbox at articles 31 and 32 and the startup visa at article 15, a three-year renewable residence card with an automatic work permit are provided for with no admission or issue on record.	MIXED the Startup Act came into force in December 2025 while none of the decrees carrying its label, sandbox, visa or fund has been made
DR Congo	Start-ups are fully exempted under Digital Code article 384, while the Startup Act's implementing texts remain in preparation. An interministerial order took effect on signature on 20 July 2026 with a two-tier dollar schedule keyed to whether a provider is judged dominant: cloud services US\$5,000 local and US\$15,000 foreign in the first tier against US\$2,500 and US\$10,000 in the second, data-centre declaration from US\$25,000 to US\$100,000 by tier, and one startup line at US\$100. A suspension announced on 1 August was denied on 6 August, neither position resting on a published text, and the ministry's 8 August statement confirmed registered start-ups are fully exempt. The four draft decrees adopted in May 2025 to operationalise the 2022 ordinance-law are still in preparation, so no exemption regime for start-ups is in force fifteen months on.	MIXED start-ups were exempted from the new digital-sector duty schedule while the Startup Act's four implementing decrees stayed in preparation

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Egypt	The country led the continent with US\$327m raised in the first half of 2026, while funded ventures fell 15.7% in 2025. 51 startups were funded in 2024, the highest count in Africa. In 2025 one tracker counts US\$378.95m across 43 funded startups, second to Nigeria for a second year, the number of funded ventures falling 15.7% while the average raise rose to US\$8.81m; the country then led the continent in the first half of 2026 with US\$327m raised. Two companies left independent operation: a semiconductor startup was acquired by a United States chip manufacturer, and an infrastructure company's team joined a United States platform company as a talent acquisition, with no consideration or asset transfer disclosed. A financial regulator sandbox cleared two of seven preliminarily approved projects to three-month live testing in its first year, from 49 applications. On the composite measure the country ranked 86th of 133 economies in the 2024 innovation index, 95th on innovation inputs and 80th on outputs - so the funding lead sits on inputs ranked in the bottom third. No later edition is held. A continental census of AI startups published in May 2026 counts 13 firms located in Egypt, sixth of the 22 countries it surveys. Its earlier editions are not held, so no direction can be read from it.	MIXED the country led the continent for funds raised in the first half of 2026 while the number of funded ventures fell and two companies left independent operation
Equatorial Guinea	A digital marketplace launched in August 2026 as a structured replacement for the messaging groups that carry much of the country's informal commerce. It was launched before ministers by its founder; it is a private platform and no user count, payment integration or regulatory status is published (marketplace). A separate platform is named by the ministry as the national electronic commerce platform, on which small firms, traders and farmers are to be trained to open free online stores, and is organising the country's first electronic commerce and digital payments workshop for September and October 2026; no ownership, transaction volume, merchant count or launch date for the platform itself is stated (national platform).	ADVANCED
Eritrea	A self-organised collective released five Tigrinya-language education applications built to the national curriculum, with no stated funding or distribution channel. 2026-08-15 — an interview carried by the state information ministry describes five applications from the Shambko Apps Group: literacy, puzzle, cultural-heritage and arithmetic tools written against the national curriculum, with a stated plan to extend them to Eritrea's eight other national languages. The group is a private collective rather than a state programme. Nothing is stated about download counts, distribution channel or funding, and no hub, incubator, investor or company registration appears elsewhere on the ledger — so this is one collective on the record, not evidence of a startup base.	ADVANCED
Eswatini	A private accelerator's first cohort passed E1 million in combined revenue, and the FinTech Strategy commits to sandbox expansion. Six entrepreneurs in the first cohort of a privately run accelerator generated more than E1 million in combined revenue within a year, and a second cohort of four businesses launched in August 2026 (accelerator). The FinTech Strategy 2025-2030 is in force and targets 500,000 electronic know-your-customer users and 80 per cent interoperability by 2028, the base's clearest statement of a startup-finance and sandbox commitment (strategy). The one domestic digital business the base tracks by name holds a provisional banking licence with no launch date. No count of startups, funding raised or exits is published. 2026-09-05 - a state-facing platform changed hands: a Taiwan-funded platform connecting local businesses to wider markets was handed to the investment promotion authority at the international trade fair, with funding for a third-phase scale-up still being sought. No listing count, transaction volume, cost or phase-three budget is published, so a platform is transferred with its running costs unstated. Three days earlier about 150 delegates met at Manzini under a United Nations enterprise programme on cutting small-enterprise costs with digital tools, with no follow-on commitment published.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Ethiopia	A startup proclamation created statutory designation, a grant programme and a credit-guarantee fund (proclamation). The Startup Proclamation 1396/2025, published in the federal gazette in September 2025, creates a designation for startups and for "ecosystem builders", a digital startup portal, a national startup designation committee, a startup grant programme, a credit-guarantee fund and a fund of funds (proclamation). The Addis Ababa e-mobility startup Dodai closed a US\$13m Series A in April 2026, US\$8m of equity and US\$5m of debt (announcement). The Artificial Intelligence University Innovation Pod was inaugurated in February 2026 with the AI institute, UNDP and Addis Ababa University, adding domestic research and incubation infrastructure (launch). The base holds no count of designated startups or of grants made under the new statute.	ADVANCED
Gabon	A national start-up accelerator launched in July 2026 reports 155 registrations and 66 shortlisted, its final pushed to the autumn. It launched with the employers' federation offering finance, technology, labelling and market access, on organisers' estimates of 150 to 200 start-ups in the country (launch). The final set for 4 August was postponed on 6 August after participating start-ups objected to how the edition was organised (postponement), and a revised agenda of 11 August moves it to late September or early October, reporting 155 registered start-ups, 133 submitting against 16 challenges and 66 shortlisted, all its own figures with no laureate list or criteria held. A Start-up and Digital Enterprise Act is named as forthcoming by the minister, with no bill, gazetted text or timetable (the Act). One domestic firm has scaled without the accelerator: a payments company grew its merchant and agent network from about 500 to more than 5,000 across all nine provinces and became the first fintech in central Africa licensed by the supranational banking supervisor to operate across the monetary union, on US\$150,000 of grant funding from a United Nations fund. No licence date or transaction volume is given.	ADVANCED final postponed
Gambia	A blockchain platform memorandum signed in January 2025 has produced no build, pilot, funding or withdrawal in nineteen months. Nothing is on record being built under it (memorandum). No startup instrument, register, fund or incubator appears anywhere in the base, so a dormant memorandum is the entire startup record.	NO CHANGE
Ghana	An innovation and startup bill has been under development since at least September 2024 with no draft published and none laid. A three-year programme reported 12 prototypes and 18 digital solutions adapted for informal entrepreneurs (report), and a facility announced US\$500,000 of new investments in Ghanaian startups (announcement). The bill is tied to a national financial-technology fund it would give a legal base; the fund has no size, source or date (bill and fund). A scouting programme identified 12,000 young innovators against a 5,000 target by working through chiefs, women's groups and disability advocates across all 16 regions rather than online applications; no independent evaluation is held. The one external reading has not moved. The 2025 innovation index places the country 101st of 139 economies, 8th of 32 in sub-Saharan Africa, with innovation inputs at 108th - unchanged on the previous year - and outputs at 93rd. Outputs ahead of inputs is the shape of a country producing more than it is resourced for. A continental census of AI startups published in May 2026 counts 15 firms located in Ghana, fourth of the 22 countries it surveys. Its earlier editions are not held, so no direction can be read from it.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Guinea	The startup law was still a draft under relecture in April 2025, and no act has been published. The commerce ministry's secretary general chaired a relecture session on the draft startup law on 29 April 2025, with the higher education and telecommunications ministries, stating its objects as an adapted legal and fiscal environment, better access to finance and public-private partnerships, and stronger competitiveness for young innovative firms. No promulgated act, law number or Journal Officiel publication is held. A Guinean startup alliance was founded in October 2025, the SabouTech incubator is running, and a national innovation strategy was put out to tender in August 2026. No innovation fund instrument is held. The country ranked 133rd of 139 economies in the 2025 Global Innovation Index and 27th of 32 in sub-Saharan Africa, having stood 128th in the 2023 edition; the 2024 edition carries no ranking for it (index).	STALLED the startup law has been in draft since April 2025 with no act promulgated
Guinea-Bissau	A digital economy fund selected its first cohort of 30 projects in March 2026. The fund and the programme launched together: a digital economy cluster and entrepreneurship fund opened in Bissau in October 2025, and selected its first cohort of 30 digital entrepreneurship projects in March 2026 under the regional digital programme. No investment total, company count or survival figure is published. The 52 proposals to a single incubator in 2025 is the base's only measure of demand.	ADVANCED
Kenya	Startup funding fell to US\$126m in the first half of 2026, the weakest half since early 2021, from US\$1.04bn raised in 2025. Equity was US\$46m of the half-year total and the country ranked third in Africa, against first place and 72 per cent year-on-year growth in 2025 (half-year); trackers disagree on both the 2025 total and the 2026 rank (half-year, full year). About US\$500m was raised across a named set of companies that have since shut down, on a publication's retrospective across five firms with no full sample, period or methodology stated (failures). The country placed 96th of 133 economies in the Global Innovation Index 2024, 6th of the 27 ranked in Sub-Saharan Africa. A continental census of AI startups published in May 2026 counts 34 firms located in Kenya, out of 224 across 22 countries and a Pan-African category founded between 2002 and 2025. The deposit's 2022 and 2025 editions are not held, so no direction can be read from it. A platform matching freelancers to work through local cybercafes reports more than 1,650 registered users, over 500 of them freelancers, and 200 partner cybercafes, with escrow settlement over mobile money and expansion into five other markets; the counts are the company's own.	REGRESSED
Lesotho	A UNDP and Econet memorandum was renewed in July 2026 across three pillars, one of them small-business digital entrepreneurship. The memorandum was signed at Maseru on 28 July 2026, renewing a partnership first signed in 2020 and amended in 2022 (signing, account). Its three pillars are digital transformation, connectivity and artificial intelligence; support for innovation; and digital entrepreneurship among micro, small and medium enterprises. No amount, term or deliverable is stated, and no count of new firms or of firms reached is held.	ADVANCED
Liberia	LiYEPA opened in June 2026 with milestone grants of up to US\$8,000 for five small enterprises. The accelerator opened on 30 June 2026 targets 100 to 120 innovators, 10 market-ready prototypes and five small enterprises at up to US\$8,000 each on milestone-based release, with 40 per cent women-led, run with a local innovation hub, the commerce ministry and the university. It sits alongside the innovation and digital hub already on the ledger. The base holds no count of Liberian startups, no investment series and no survival data, so new firms are visible only through the programmes that fund them.	ADVANCED
Libya	A state seed fund was created in January 2025, requiring an AI-screened application platform. The decision creates a fund to support and guarantee financing for startup innovation companies, and requires applications to run through an artificial-intelligence-screened platform. Demand is visible where it has been counted: more than 600 entries to a single university technology competition in 2026. No count of Libyan startups, investment total or survival rate is published.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Madagascar	The country was placed behind regional comparators on a 2025 index of the digital entrepreneurship environment, reported at second hand. The placement was reported through a development agency in December 2025, on an index the base holds only at second hand and carries as a dated citation rather than as current state (index). No count of firms, funding raised, incubator or accelerator is held for the country, so the position is the whole of the evidence and its components are not visible.	NO CHANGE a single indexed position with nothing earlier behind it
Malawi	ICT services exports rose from about US\$70m in 2020 to US\$154m in 2023 on an industry account, while the country fell to 125th of 139 economies in the 2025 innovation index. The export series was cited by a private-sector managing director as evidence that the sector already earns foreign currency; the underlying figures are dollars, undated as to conversion, and are an industry speaker's rather than an official statistic (exports). The aggregator was founded in 2021 and offers small-business tools including interfaces, plugins, payment links, invoicing and analytics; the profile is company-reported throughout and carries no dated event, transaction volume or revenue figure (aggregator, transfers). The Global Innovation Index 2025 places the country 125th of 139 economies, 5th of the 11 low-income economies and 20th of the 32 ranked in Sub-Saharan Africa, with inputs at 122nd against outputs at 131st; it was 111th in 2020 and 107th in 2021, with no placing in 2022, 2023 or 2024, and holds no cluster in the index's top innovation clusters (index). The ranked field grew over those years, so part of the fall is a larger denominator, and the index's own confidence interval for the placing spans 23 places.	MIXED an export series and a payment aggregator against a falling innovation ranking
Mali	A startups law was recommended at the national digital week in August 2026, and nothing has been tabled. The recommendation sits alongside the digital council and the data-management law in the same set of sovereignty proposals (recommendation). No draft, definition of a startup, register or count of firms is held for the country, so the base records an intention to create a legal status and no measure of the population it would apply to.	ADVANCED
Mauritania	A Startup Act was promulgated in January 2024 with a merit-based label, a state-backed fund and procurement preference, and its enacted text is not held. The draft that went to consultation targeted 300 labelled start-ups and 3,000 jobs over five years, and set out a merit-based label with a preferential public-procurement margin, a state-backed start-up fund and guarantee fund with investor tax incentives, payroll-cost relief, a technology-innovation hub, and intellectual property and customs relief (draft). The law was promulgated on 2 January 2024 (promulgation). The promulgated text itself is not held, so whether those provisions survived into law cannot be established, and no count of labelled firms, fund disbursements or jobs has been published since.	ADVANCED
Mauritius	A start-up package was carried in the 2026-2027 budget and an AI start-ups initiative showcased in May 2026. The investment promotion agency's account of the innovation environment is the standing description (account). An artificial-intelligence start-ups initiative was showcased in May 2026 (showcase). A start-up package was carried in the 2026-2027 budget in June (budget). No funding total, company count or survival figure is held for any of it.	ADVANCED
Morocco	The development agency's database lists 1,028 start-ups on a January 2025 release, and a govtech challenge opened a public sourcing channel in July 2026. The 2024 file released on the national open-data portal carries 1,028 entries, the union of four listing exercises, with no funding amounts, no definition of a start-up and unnormalised city and sector fields, so the number is a count of rows (database). A GovTech Innovation Challenge was launched in Rabat in July 2026 as a sourcing channel for public-audit and public financial management tools, with the general finance inspectorate and the court of audit as institutional users and no budget or timetable announced (challenge).	NO CHANGE the start-up count has not been republished since January 2025
Mozambique	The country ranked 128th of 133 economies in the Global Innovation Index 2024, and 22nd of the 27 ranked in Sub-Saharan Africa. The Global Innovation Index 2024 places the country 128th of 133 economies and 22nd of the 27 ranked in Sub-Saharan Africa (index). The held capture is a machine extraction of the index's country profile in which some running text is scrambled, so the ranks above are the legible figures and no pillar scores are read from it. The base holds no start-up statute, no national innovation or research funding programme and no register of technology firms, all of which stand as not held.	NO CHANGE a first placing with no earlier reading held on this base

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Namibia	Cabinet authorised an information technology venture capital fund at US\$20m and directed engagement with female founders as potential beneficiaries. No fund manager, first close, instrument, Namibian-dollar figure or disbursement is on file eleven months later (fund). The amount is published only in United States dollars, so the row cannot carry the announcing party's own currency, and no count of firms, deals or jobs is held for the country.	NO CHANGE a fund authorised at US\$20m with no manager, close or disbursement on file
Niger	Four firms are named by the digital agency as supported, with no funding, company count or outcome published. The agency named four companies in August 2025 as supported (firms). No funding figure, register, definition or count of firms is held for the country, so support is recorded by example and the population it applies to is unknown.	NO CHANGE
Nigeria	A drive-to-own vehicle financier reached a US\$2.1bn valuation on a 42,000-vehicle fleet, a diaspora remittance product was wound down, and the largest payments processor folded in a third acquired brand. About 25,000 small and medium enterprises are to receive N20bn in software credits (announcement); no take-up figure is held. The drive-to-own financier, founded in Nigeria in 2020 and now headquartered in Dubai, raised US\$250m at a US\$2.1bn valuation (valuation); it makes ride-hailing earnings a credit-scoring rail for drivers outside formal banking, and no Nigerian instrument addresses that underwriting (round). A Nigerian group is phasing out its UK diaspora remittance product less than eighteen months after launch, having committed 1.2 million pounds in setup expenditure (wind-down). A crowdsourced food-price platform reached about 2,500 users (prices). The largest payments processor is winding down a card-issuing fintech acquired in an unannounced 2025 deal – the third brand folded in, none with a disclosed value. A continental census of AI startups published in May 2026 counts 50 firms located in Nigeria, the largest national count of 22 countries surveyed. Its earlier editions are not held, so no direction can be read from it. An EU, European Investment Bank and African Development Bank initiative was stated at its Abuja forum on 9 September 2026 to have attracted more than EUR100 million (forum), cumulative across sub-Saharan Africa rather than a dated Nigerian commitment.	ADVANCED
Rwanda	An innovation fund had backed twelve companies by 2024, reported second-hand with no fund document held. Twelve companies had been backed by 2024, on a second-hand report (fund). No fund document, size, mandate or portfolio is held. Against a national ambition that runs to an innovation city, a financial technology centre and an artificial-intelligence agency, twelve companies is the only portfolio figure the base can state.	NO CHANGE
Sao Tome and Principe	The startup competition reached its third edition in July 2026 focused on women-led entrepreneurship, having funded four projects from US\$8,000 to US\$12,000 in the second. The earlier innovation fund awarded up to US\$5,000 each to 26 projects from a fund of US\$130,000, drawing 456 valid applications, forming five training classes and taking 27 of a further 73 applications into incubation (fund). The second edition drew more than 150 applications, selected 33 young people for five weeks of intensive training with due-diligence visits, and funded four projects at US\$12,000, US\$10,000 and two at US\$8,000 (second edition). The third launched in July 2026 focused on women-led entrepreneurship, run by the finance ministry's entrepreneurship directorate with the incubator network and development-agency financing, over four phases from registration to a final pitch (third edition). Three editions on donor money and no domestic funding line.	ADVANCED
Senegal	The Startup Act labelling process launched in the strategy's first year against a 2034 target of more than 500 labelled firms, and no count of labelled startups is held. The implementing decree was adopted in January 2025 and the labelling process launched in the strategy's first year; the published target for 2034 is more than 500 and no count is held at any date (labelling, implementation). A corporate mobility platform launched in July 2026, its claimed cost reduction the company's own (mobility). A transit operator and the telecommunications operator signed a super-app partnership in July 2026, described as progressive and eventual throughout with no go-live date or phasing published (super-app).	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Seychelles	Cabinet tightened the Seed Capital Grant Scheme in May 2026 on youth eligibility, repeat applicants and evaluation flexibility. The revisions cover a clearer definition of a youth beneficiary, revised eligibility, safeguards against repeat applicants, more flexible evaluation and extended implementation periods (Cabinet); the same sitting approved a Government Service Centre linked to the business portal. Two incubators opened around it: the university centre in 2025 (centre) and a trust-run incubator offering seed funding access in August 2026 (incubator). No grant count, disbursement total or survival rate of funded ventures is published, so the scheme's scale is unknown even as its rules tighten.	ADVANCED
Sierra Leone	An angel investment network opened with a ministry framework agreement in December 2025, above a mapping of the entrepreneurship support organisations that serve founders. The Redsalt Angel Investment Network launched alongside a framework agreement with the ministry to co-fund and support early-stage startups (network). The International Trade Centre published a digital roadmap mapping the country's entrepreneurship support organisations (roadmap), and an e-commerce startup reached the Startup World Cup regional semi-finals in November 2025 (startup). No fund size, deal count or portfolio is published for the network. The advisory council recorded separately is the only standing governance the sector has.	ADVANCED
Somalia	A national startup network was launched at an innovation forum in July 2026, and the regulator signed a partnership with a technology hub the same month. The network was launched on 22 July 2026, and the same account states that intellectual-property legislation is being developed with no bill, text or timeline on file (network). The regulator signed a memorandum with a technology hub on 30 July 2026 (partnership). No member count, funding, programme or startup figure is published for either.	ADVANCED
South Africa	Venture funding fell from \$335.9m across 42 ventures in 2025, leading the continent, to fourth place at \$83m in the first half of 2026. Funding reversed inside the window. The country raised \$335.9m across 42 ventures in calendar 2025 on a measure its publisher describes as a minimum floor, leading the continent. 2026-07-27 — in the first half of 2026 it ranked fourth at \$83m, as continental deal count fell 42% year on year and early-stage activity thinned. The two halves are not strictly comparable — a full year against a half — but the ranking is, and first to fourth on the continent in six months is the finding. No domestic count of hubs, incubators, registrations or exits appears on this ledger to set against it, so the only visible measure of the startup base is the money going into it. A continental census of AI startups published in May 2026 counts 49 firms located in South Africa, out of 224 across 22 countries and a Pan-African category founded between 2002 and 2025. The deposit's 2022 and 2025 editions are not held, so no direction can be read from it.	REGRESSED
South Sudan	A four-year incubator for 350 small enterprises launched in April 2026, above a pitch competition that awarded EUR 90,000. A pitch competition in Juba on 26 September 2025 saw 24 entrepreneurs compete and seven share EUR 90,000 in grants (competition). A European Union-funded incubator running 2026 to 2029 launched on 16 April 2026 at the University of Juba, targeting incubation, acceleration and finance for 350 small and medium enterprises across seven regions, 30 per cent women-led and more than half youth-led (incubator). Both are donor-financed and neither reports a company formed, funded or grown beyond its own cohort.	ADVANCED
Sudan	Eight startups secured over SDG 500 million at a December demo day, and 35 entrepreneurs from six states were selected in July 2026. The sixth demo day concluded with eight startups in renewable energy, agriculture and healthcare collectively securing over SDG 500 million in growth investment through an innovation fund, subject to due diligence (demo day). Batch 9 selected 35 entrepreneurs from Khartoum, Kassala, Al Jazirah, Red Sea, Gedaref and White Nile across nine sectors, with many ventures using digital tools (announcement). A youth entrepreneurship programme for 500 people launched in Kassala in November 2025 under a memorandum with the state ministry (launch). Recruitment is nationwide despite the war; no sector-wide financing total is published.	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Tanzania	842 startups were counted with no dedicated startup act, and a four-year ventures programme targets 1,000 by 2029. A national assessment of the startup sector counts 842 known startups, 136 support organisations and 112,119 jobs, and expressly records the absence of a dedicated startup policy or act. A four-year national ventures programme launched in March 2026 targeting about 250 ventures a year and 1,000 startups across six sectors by 2029, run by the science commission with three innovation partners. A joint intellectual-property programme launched in August 2026 targets 5,000 trainees and assessments for 120 innovators in its first year. The absence of a startup statute is the assessment's own finding and nothing since has closed it. 2026-09-07 - a private channel opened alongside the state programme: a three-year partnership between the leading mobile operator and a global entrepreneurship network to reach 1,000 entrepreneurs and 40 ventures, with a first cohort of entrepreneur-support organisations due in October 2026. No commitment amount is stated, so it carries targets and no measurable resource behind them.	ADVANCED
Togo	A national digital start-up association was officially launched under the digital minister in October 2025. Revenue and jobs claims are association-reported, and no membership, revenue or jobs figure has been published since launch (association). It is the only start-up item in this ledger. Ten months after launch the base holds nothing further on it.	ADVANCED
Tunisia	The startup statute and its national programme were adopted as the curriculum of a Japanese-financed programme for other African states. The adoption was reported in July 2026 (curriculum). No domestic figure — labelled companies, funding raised, jobs — appears anywhere in this ledger. A framework being exported as a model while its own outcomes go unmeasured at home is what the record supports. A continental census of AI startups published in May 2026 counts 14 firms located in Tunisia, out of 224 across 22 countries and a Pan-African category founded between 2002 and 2025. The deposit's 2022 and 2025 editions are not held, so no direction can be read from it.	ADVANCED
Uganda	A national innovator registry excludes joint ventures with foreign firms and confers no contract, and a three-year startup income-tax exemption was proposed with no enactment recorded. The registry's gazettelement was scheduled for July 2026 with no confirmation held; it excludes joint ventures with foreign firms and enrolment confers no contract (registry, prototype). The tax exemption was proposed in 2025 income tax bill amendments with no enactment recorded, and is distinct from a small-capital exemption in force from July 2025 (exemption). Startups raising disclosed funding are counted by a publisher from disclosed rounds only and are not comparable with the investment series (funding), and a diversity study samples more than 3,000 startups with no prior national figure held (diversity). 2026-08-31 — a continental alliance and the ICT ministry validated a national digital entrepreneurship and innovation assessment at a Kampala workshop, which named as priorities advancing the Startup Bill, strengthening science, technology and innovation policy, widening access to regulatory sandboxes and using public procurement to open markets to local startups. The assessment text is not published and no reform is dated or budgeted; the Startup Bill itself is carried on this ledger as not held, the base holding no text, stage or timetable for it.	ADVANCED
Zambia	A Startup Bill was named by a ministry representative — its first and only mention in the base — and a technology company listed on the domestic securities exchange. The bill's mention is the first and only one in the base (bill). The listing is described as recent (listing), and a company founded in 2025 was profiled in July 2026 (company). A continental diversity report's third edition gives the female co-founder and chief executive share; the underlying report is not held and only the trade-press account is (diversity).	ADVANCED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Zimbabwe	A national artificial-intelligence innovation fund is named in the strategy and a separate catalyst fund was announced in August 2026, and the two are not stated to be the same vehicle. The strategy names one fund and a catalyst fund was announced at a grand challenge launch; the two are not stated to be the same vehicle (fund, catalyst, launch). A ring-fenced share of the universal services fund is committed for public-good artificial intelligence with no amount stated (ring-fenced). The central bank cites a regulatory sandbox as operating, pre-dating the window with no earlier position held (sandbox), and an innovation hub was announced as to be created under the new department (hub).	ADVANCED

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